VERSION 1 · NOVEMBER 2026

How the Menu X-ray *handles data.*

What is stored, where, for how long, and who can see it. Written for owners who use the tool, and for the PIHOCO team who run it.

STAYS IN THE BROWSER

The menu file, OCR, all scoring and money maths, covers and average bill.

STORED BY PIHOCO

The reviewed menu items and result, leads who ask for a scorecard, public price data.

NEVER

No AI model reads a menu. Nothing is sold or shared for advertising.

01 · THE SHORT VERSION

Most of the work happens on *the owner's own device.*

The X-ray engine is plain code that runs inside the visitor's browser. Their menu is read, checked and scored there. Only the finished result is saved, so it can be shared and reviewed.

BROWSER ONLY

Never leaves the device

- The uploaded PDF or photo (read with pdf.js and Tesseract, on the device)
- Covers per week and average bill
- Money estimates and slider values
- The working session (kept in the browser tab until it is closed)

SAVED

Stored in the database

- The reviewed menu items (dish, description, price, section)
- The X-ray result (score, findings, rewrites)
- Restaurant name, city, country, concept, cuisine
- A random share code for the result link
- Leads: name, email, WhatsApp, consent, only when the owner asks for the scorecard

NEVER

Not collected, not done

- No AI or machine-learning model reads the menu or is trained on it
- No sales, recipe-cost or POS data in the free tool
- No advertising trackers in the app
- Covers and bill are not stored unless the owner ticks "share with PIHOCO" on the lead form, and then they go only into the email to PIHOCO

One exception to "browser only". When an owner asks for the full scorecard, the lead form emails PIHOCO a summary: their name, contact details, score, top findings, the share link, and the pasted menu text. Covers and bill are included only if they tick the share box. This email goes through Web3Forms to the same inbox as the website forms.

02 · THE JOURNEY OF ONE X-RAY

From a pasted menu to a *shared result.*

OWNER'S BROWSER

Read & score

Menu text, PDF or photo → dishes and prices → owner fixes rows → engine scores five parts, finds fixes, prices levers.

→

PIHOCO DATABASE

Save the result

Items + result + place details saved to **audits** with a random share code. Covers and bill are not sent.

→

SHARE LINK

Read-only page

`/app/x/<code>` shows the stored result. It can't list or open any other audit.

BEFORE SCORING

Fetch public data

The browser reads local menu prices for the owner's city and the official price index for their country.

↻

LEAD FORM

Scorecard request

Name, email, WhatsApp, consent → **leads** table, plus one email to PIHOCO via Web3Forms.

→

PRICE CHECK (OPTIONAL)

Competitor prices

Pasted competitor menus are compared in the browser. If the owner ticks the box, their public prices are added to the index, unverified.

STEP	WHERE IT RUNS	WHAT CROSSES THE NETWORK
Upload a PDF or photo	Browser (pdf.js, Tesseract.js)	Nothing about the file. Tesseract downloads its reading engine and English language data from a public CDN the first time.
Parse, review, score, money	Browser (PIHOCO engine)	Nothing
Load local prices	Browser → database	The city name (to filter); prices come back
Save result	Browser → database	Items, result, place details (no covers or bill)
Find nearby places	Browser → OpenStreetMap	The area and city typed by the owner, only when they press the button
Ask for the scorecard	Browser → database + Web3Forms	Lead details and result summary (see page 02)

03 · THE DATABASE

Four tables, *locked by default.*

Database: PIHOCO's own Supabase project (PostgreSQL 17), hosted in AWS **ap-south-1 (Mumbai)**. Every table has row-level security on. The public website key can only do what is listed below. Everything else is refused by the database itself, not just hidden by the app.

TABLE	WHAT'S IN IT	PUBLIC CAN…	RULES ENFORCED BY THE DATABASE
audits	Restaurant name, city, country, currency, concept, cuisine, reviewed menu items, X-ray result, share code, time	Add a row. **Cannot read, change or delete.**	Covers/bill field must be empty; size limits; share code 6–40 chars
leads	Name, email, WhatsApp (optional), consent, status, link to audit, time; private notes field for PIHOCO	Add a row. **Cannot read, change or delete.**	Consent must be ticked; valid email; length limits; status must start as "new"; notes must be empty
benchmark_items	Public menu prices: city, area, dish key, dish name, price, currency, channel, source link, date, who added it, verified flag	Read all. Add rows only as "price_check" and unverified.	Price 0–100,000; known currency; length limits; cannot mark rows verified
price_index	Monthly official restaurant-price index points by country, with source	Read all.	Unique per country and month; no public writes

Two public functions

`get_shared_audit(code)` returns one result for one share code: the score, findings and place details. Never the menu items, covers, bill or any contact details, and never a list of audits.

`public_stats()` returns counts only (menus, prices, dishes, X-rays) for the live numbers on the website.

One private view

`leads_inbox` joins each lead to its restaurant, city and score for the PIHOCO team. The public key has no access to it.

Checked on 10 Nov 2026 by acting as the public user: reading leads or audits returns nothing, writing to the price index is refused, a lead without consent is refused.

04 · WHO TOUCHES THE DATA

Five services, *each with one job.*

SERVICE	JOB	WHAT IT RECEIVES
Vercel	Hosts the website and the app (static files)	Standard web request logs (IP, page). No form data passes through it.
Supabase	Database for audits, leads and price data	Everything described on page 04. Encrypted in transit (HTTPS) and at rest.
Web3Forms	Emails each scorecard request to PIHOCO	The lead email contents (page 02)
OpenStreetMap (Nominatim, Overpass)	Finds similar places nearby, on request	The area and city typed in. Results © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).
jsDelivr CDN	Delivers the open-source photo reader (Tesseract) on first use	A normal file download. The photo itself is never sent.

Keys and access

- The app uses Supabase's **publishable** key, which is designed to be public. Its power is limited by the rules on page 04.
- The Web3Forms key only sends to PIHOCO's own inbox.
- Admin access is through the Supabase dashboard login only. Use two-factor sign-in on that account.
- No secret keys are in the website or app code.

Share links

- Each result gets a random 10-character code (about 8×10^{14} combinations). Codes can't be guessed in practice.
- A link shows one result, read-only, without covers or bill.
- Anyone holding the link can view it, the same as a shared document link. Tell owners this on the share button.

> **Not used:** AI or language-model APIs, Lovable Cloud, advertising pixels, data brokers. The app was rebuilt outside Lovable on 10 Nov 2026; the old Lovable project holds no live data.

05 · WHERE THE COMPARISON DATA COMES FROM

Every number has *a source.*

560
MENU PRICES

14
PUBLIC DUBAI MENUS

22
DISHES WITH 5+ VENUES

DATASET	WHAT AND HOW	RULES
Dubai menu prices benchmark_items · pihoco_research	Dine-in prices copied from menus on venues' own websites on 10 Nov 2026: 4 restaurants, 10 cafés. Source link stored per price.	No delivery apps (their terms forbid copying). One price per venue per dish (the regular size). A dish is compared only with 5+ venues.
Owner contributions benchmark_items · price_check	Competitor prices pasted into Price Check by owners who tick the box.	Stored as unverified. Review before using in public claims.
US restaurant inflation price_index · US	BLS CPI-U "Food away from home" (CUUR0000SEFV): index levels via FRED, earlier months derived from BLS monthly and 12-month changes.	Mar 2025 – Sep 2026.
UK restaurant inflation price_index · GB	ONS CPI annual rate, division 11 "Hotels, cafés and restaurants" (D7GI). Monthly levels chained from the annual rates.	An estimate, labelled as one. Jan 2024 – Sep 2026.
Dish dictionary in the app code	About 130 dishes with alternative names and suggested descriptions, written by PIHOCO from classic recipes.	Suggestions are starting points: owners must check them against their recipe.
Nearby places	OpenStreetMap, live, on request.	Not stored. Attribution shown.

Not yet loaded: UAE, India and Singapore inflation. Dubai's published series mixes hotels with restaurants and India rebased its index in 2026; both need a clean monthly series first.

06 · RETENTION, REQUESTS AND DAY-TO-DAY ADMIN

Keep only what's *useful.*

Recommended retention

DATA	KEEP FOR
Audits without a lead	12 months, then delete
Audits linked to a lead	As long as the lead is kept
Leads not converted	24 months after last contact
Clients	Contract length + legal minimum
Public price data	Kept; mark stale after 90 days

These are PIHOCO's policy choices, not yet automated. A monthly reminder to run the clean-up is enough at this volume.

When an owner asks

- **"Delete my data"**: delete their lead row, and the audit it links to, in the Supabase table editor. Reply to confirm within 7 days.
- **"What do you hold?"**: export their lead and audit rows as CSV from the table editor.
- **"Take my result link down"**: delete the audit row; the link stops working.

Day-to-day admin (Supabase dashboard)

01 **See new leads.** Table editor → view `leads_inbox`. Newest first, with restaurant, city and score.

02 **Track a lead.** In `leads`, change `status`: new → scorecard sent → call booked → proposal → won / lost. Use `notes` for anything else.

03 **Open their result.** Go to `/app/x/<share_id>` using the share id in the inbox.

04 **Add a public menu.** Paste it into `data/` on the `menu-xray-engine` branch and rerun the seed script (dish keys are matched automatically).

05 **Add an inflation month.** Insert one row in `price_index`: country, month (YYYY-MM), value, source.

06 **Review owner prices.** Filter `benchmark_items` by `added_by = price_check`; set `verified` after checking the source.

> Questions about data: **contact@pihoco.com**. Privacy page: pihoco.com/privacy.html. Update it to mention the Menu X-ray, using pages 02–05 of this document.